

Hosting & Infrastructure Guide

GreenGeeks deployment, domains & Beem SMS for UjuziLab

GreenGeeks VPS & shared hosting (USD list prices + TZS)

Domain options: .com via GreenGeeks, .co.tz via TZ registrars

Beem Africa SMS API - Tanzania tiered pricing (TZS/SMS)

Recommended stack for Next.js 14 + MySQL + file uploads

FX rate: 1 USD = 2,620.42 TZS (BoT mean, 11 June 2026)

Research date: 15 June 2026

RECOMMENDED PLAN

GreenGeeks VPS 8 GB (Self-Managed): \$19.99/mo intro (TZS 52,382/mo) | Renews \$39.99/mo (TZS 104,791/mo) + ujuzilab.co.tz (~TZS 20,000) + Beem SMS from TZS 20/SMS

1. Recommendation for UjuziLab

UjuziLab is a Next.js 14 application with server actions, Prisma, MySQL, sessions, and video uploads up to 500 MB. It needs Node.js, a persistent process (PM2), and dedicated RAM - not a basic PHP/WordPress-only shared account.

- RECOMMENDED: GreenGeeks VPS 8 GB (Self-Managed) - intro \$19.99/mo (TZS 52,382/mo), renews at \$39.99/mo (TZS 104,791/mo). 4 vCPU, 8 GB RAM, 160 GB SSD.
- ALTERNATIVE (managed support): GreenGeeks Managed VPS 8 GB - \$129.95/mo (TZS 340,524/mo). 6 vCPU, 8 GB RAM, 150 GB SSD, proactive monitoring.
- BUDGET / STAGING ONLY: EcoSite Premium shared - intro \$8.95/mo (TZS 23,453/mo). Node.js via cPanel but limited RAM, no PM2 on shared - not ideal for production LMS.
- NOT RECOMMENDED for production: Lite or Pro shared plans - no Node.js support per GreenGeeks documentation.

2. GreenGeeks shared hosting (12-month prepaid)

Source: greengeeks.com/pricing (June 2026). Intro rates require 12-month prepayment. Free .com domain year 1 on annual plans.

Plan	USD / month	TZS / month
Lite (intro / renew)	\$2.95 / \$13.95	TZS 7,730 / TZS 36,555
Pro (intro / renew)	\$4.95 / \$18.95	TZS 12,971 / TZS 49,657
Premium (intro / renew)	\$8.95 / \$30.95	TZS 23,453 / TZS 81,102
Year 1 total (Premium)	\$107.40 prepaid	TZS 281,433
Year 2+ annual (Premium)	\$371.40/yr	TZS 973,224

- Premium: 100 GB SSD, unlimited sites, Node.js on EcoSite Premium servers, free SSL, CDN, daily backups.
- Lite/Pro: 25-50 GB SSD - suitable for marketing landing pages only, not the full UjuziLab app.

3. GreenGeeks VPS hosting

VPS is the right tier for production Next.js. Choose Managed for hands-on support or Self-Managed for lower cost.

Plan	USD / month	TZS / month
Managed VPS 4 GB	\$69.95	TZS 183,298
Managed VPS 8 GB	\$129.95	TZS 340,524
Managed VPS 16 GB	\$179.95	TZS 471,545
Self VPS 4 GB (intro/renew)	\$9.99 / \$19.99	TZS 26,178 / TZS 52,382
Self VPS 8 GB (intro/renew)	\$19.99 / \$39.99	TZS 52,382 / TZS 104,791
Self VPS 16 GB (intro/renew)	\$39.99 / \$79.99	TZS 104,791 / TZS 209,607

- Deploy: Node 20 LTS, PM2, Nginx reverse proxy, MySQL 8, store uploads on SSD or S3-compatible storage.
- Set NEXTAUTH_URL to <https://yourdomain.tz>. Use GreenGeeks free SSL (Let's Encrypt).
- Pick EU or US data centre; for Tanzania users consider CDN for static assets.

4. Domain name pricing

Register .co.tz locally (TCRA) for trust in Tanzania; use GreenGeeks bundled .com for international reach.

Domain	USD / year	TZS / year
.com via GreenGeeks (yr 1 w/ hosting)	Free	Free
.com via GreenGeeks (renewal)	\$17.95	TZS 47,037
.co.tz (TZ registrars, typical)	N/A	TZS 19,500 - 25,500
.com via TZ registrar (typical)	N/A	TZS 32,000 - 50,000
ujuzilab.co.tz example (Sakurahost sale)	N/A	TZS 19,500 register
ujuzilab.co.tz renewal (typical)	N/A	TZS 25,000

- Suggested pair: ujuzilab.co.tz (primary, Tanzania) + ujuzilab.com (redirect to .co.tz or global marketing).
- GreenGeeks free domain applies to .com, .net, .org, .info, .biz on first annual hosting purchase.

5. Beem Africa SMS API (Tanzania)

Source: beem.africa/coverage (official). All networks (Vodacom, Airtel, Tigo). Sender ID registration required (7-14 working days). API: apisms.beem.africa

Monthly volume	TZS per SMS	Example cost
1 - 10,000	20	1,000 SMS = TZS 20,000
10,001 - 25,000	18	15,000 SMS = TZS 270,000
25,001 - 50,000	17	40,000 SMS = TZS 680,000
50,001 - 100,000	16	75,000 SMS = TZS 1,200,000
100,001 - 250,000	14	
250,001 - 500,000	13	
500,001 - 1,000,000	12	
1,000,001 - 2,000,000	10.7	

- Use for: OTP login, course notifications, assignment alerts, org invites (alongside email).
- Register sender name 'UJUZILAB' (max 11 chars) with business registration docs via Beem dashboard.
- Prepaid SMS credits required before sender ID approval. Contact senderid@beem.africa for current fees.
- Shortcode (optional, enterprise): dedicated toll-free setup from EUR 3,000 + annual TCRA/regulatory fees - only if you need two-way SMS.

6. Estimated Year 1 budget (recommended stack)

Assumes VPS 8 GB self-managed intro pricing, .co.tz domain, modest SMS volume.

Item	USD equiv.	TZS
GreenGeeks VPS 8 GB (12 mo intro)	\$239.88	TZS 628,586
.co.tz domain (register + renew est.)	N/A	TZS 45,000
Beem SMS 2,000 transactional/yr	N/A	TZS 40,000
SSL certificate	Free (Let's Encrypt)	Free
TOTAL Year 1 (approx.)	~\$240 + domains/SMS	TZS 713,586

- Year 2 hosting renews at \$39.99/mo = TZS 104,791/mo (TZS 1,257,487/yr).
- Add MySQL managed add-on or external DB only if you outgrow VPS - not required at launch.
- Keep Gmail SMTP for email (free tier) or use Beem SMS for critical alerts in Tanzania.

7. UjuziLab deployment checklist on GreenGeeks

- Order VPS 8 GB, point ujuzilab.co.tz A-record to VPS IP (and www CNAME).
- Install Node 20, MySQL 8, Nginx, PM2. Clone repo, set `.env` (DATABASE_URL, NEXTAUTH_SECRET, NEXTAUTH_URL).
- Run `prisma migrate deploy` && `npm run build` && `pm2 start npm --name ujuzilab -- start`.
- Configure Nginx proxy to port 3000, enable HTTPS via certbot or GreenGeeks SSL tool.
- Create Beem account, request sender ID, integrate SMS API for OTP/notifications.
- Set up daily DB backups and test restore. Monitor RAM during video upload peaks.

8. Sources & disclaimers

- GreenGeeks prices: <https://www.greengeeks.com/pricing/> (checked June 2026).
- Beem SMS Tanzania: <https://beem.africa/coverage/> (official tier table in TZS).
- USD/TZS: Bank of Tanzania indicative rate, mean 2620.42 TZS/USD on 11 June 2026.
- .co.tz pricing: Sakurahost, Duhosting, ISP.co.tz public price lists (TZ registrars vary).
- Prices change with promotions and FX. Confirm in checkout before purchase.
- GreenGeeks Node.js: limited support on Premium shared; full control on VPS (see GreenGeeks support docs).